STUDY AID · MATTHEW 10:1-15 · EPISODE 16 OF 58

Freely You *Received*



Freely you received, freely give.

▶ Watch on YouTube | Read Matthew 10:1-15 in the LSB | 27:56 | Channel: Every Word

Full title: Matthew 10:1-15 – The Ancient Gospel Message You Never Knew About!. Series: The Gospel of Matthew Every Word (playlist of 58 videos).

FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND (ADDED) · DEBATED · LSB TEXT · ◆ LOGOS FACTBOOK LINK

01 · FROM THE VIDEO

Short summary

- The teacher reads Matthew 10:1-15: Jesus summons the Twelve, gives them authority over unclean spirits and disease, names them, and sends them out with instructions. This begins His second great discourse in Matthew, the 'mission' discourse, which runs to the end of chapter 10.
- In verse 1 they are 'disciples'; in verse 2, for the only time in Matthew, they are 'apostles.' An apostle is 'one who is sent,' an authorized representative. A disciple (talmid) is being trained to be like his rabbi. Peter is named first: first among the Twelve in leadership, as Acts shows.
- How could they preach good news before the cross? Their message was 'The kingdom of heaven is at hand' (10:7), and every phrase comes out of the Old Testament: 'lost sheep' (Psalm 119:176; Jeremiah 50:6; Ezekiel 34), the King installed on Zion (Psalm 2), the Son of Man given an everlasting kingdom (Daniel 7:13-14), and the righteous Branch of David (Jeremiah 23:5-6). The good news was that the King had arrived.
- 'Freely you received, freely give' (10:8) echoes Isaiah 55:1: buy wine and milk 'without money and without cost,' leading to an everlasting covenant and the faithful lovingkindnesses of David. No money and no moral resume can buy entry to God's banquet; the only requirement is to listen and believe.
- So they take almost nothing, rely on God's provision, look for whoever is 'worthy' in each town, and stay there.

> *"The word apostle means one who is sent.*
>
> From the video (auto-captions, lightly cleaned)

> *"The good news was simply to proclaim that the king had arrived.*
>
> From the video (auto-captions, lightly cleaned)

A house that rejects them gets the dust shaken off their feet, and that town will fare worse than Sodom and Gomorrah.

- The lesson: when God sends His people on a mission, He gives them everything they need to accomplish it, even the people who need to hear. Like the Son, we do what we see the Father doing (John 5:19).



Jesus chooses the Twelve

James Tissot, Ordaining of the Twelve Apostles, 1886-1894. Brooklyn Museum via Wikimedia Commons, public domain



Matthew, 'the tax collector'

James Tissot, Saint Matthew, 1886-1894. Brooklyn Museum via Wikimedia Commons, public domain

Keep looking for connections

The teacher's tip: Jesus' words are full of the Old Testament, and he has not shown you every link. Keep looking: he points to 1 Samuel 25, Nehemiah 5 and Genesis 19 and leaves them for you to find.

The video reads from another English translation. Quotations on this page are from the LSB.

02 · FROM THE VIDEO · LSB TEXT

Scripture passages covered

The video reads all of Matthew 10:1-15 and traces its phrases to the Psalms, the Prophets and Daniel. Each link opens those verses on read.lsbible.org.

Matthew 10:1-15
Read in full: the Twelve named and sent out.

Mark 6:7-13
Mark's account: sent out in pairs.

Luke 9:1-6
Luke's account: 'Take nothing for your journey.'

Psalm 119:176
'I have wandered off like a lost sheep.'

Jeremiah 50:6
'My people have become lost sheep; their shepherds have led them astray.'

Psalm 2:6-8
The King installed on Zion; the nations as His inheritance.

Daniel 7:13-14
One like a Son of Man receives an everlasting kingdom.

Jeremiah 23:5-6
A righteous Branch for David: 'Yahweh our righteousness.'

Isaiah 55:1-3
Buy wine and milk without money; an everlasting covenant.

Isaiah 54:7-8
'With great compassion I will gather you.'

1 Samuel 25:6
'Peace be to you, and peace be to your house.'

Nehemiah 5:13
Nehemiah shakes out his garment as a sign.

Genesis 19:24-29
Fire on Sodom and Gomorrah.

John 5:19
The Son does what He sees the Father doing.

Matthew 10:16-33
Coming next: sheep among wolves.

Key verses in the LSB

“Freely you received, freely give.”

Matthew 10:8 (LSB)

“And you who have no money come, buy and eat. Come, buy wine and milk / Without money and without cost.”

Isaiah 55:1 (LSB)

“And as you go, preach, saying, ‘The kingdom of heaven is at hand.’”

Matthew 10:7 (LSB)

03 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND · LSB TEXT

Disciples become apostles

The Twelve named, paired, and sent to Israel.



DISCIPLES, THEN APOSTLES · MATTHEW 10:1-2

One who is sent

MATTHEW 10:1-2 (LSB)

APOSTLE

“And summoning His twelve disciples, Jesus gave them authority over unclean spirits, to cast them out, and to heal every kind of disease and every kind of sickness. Now the names of the twelve apostles are these: The first, Simon, who is called Peter, and Andrew his brother; and James the son of Zebedee, and John his brother;”

FROM THE VIDEO Verse 1 says 'disciples'; verse 2 says 'apostles,' the only time Matthew uses the word. An apostle is one who is sent: an emissary or ambassador who acts as an authorized representative.

FROM THE VIDEO The stages of their training: first they watch Jesus teach and heal; then they help their rabbi; now they are sent out, to report back later; finally, after the ascension, they spread His church. Mark 6:30 Luke 9:10

BACKGROUND Matthew does not narrate their trip or return. Mark and Luke do: 'the apostles gathered together with Jesus; and they reported to Him all that they had done and taught' (Mark 6:30).

◆ Factbook: The Twelve ◆ Factbook: Disciples



THE FIRST · MATTHEW 10:2

Simon, who is called Peter

MATTHEW 10:2 (LSB)

FIRST

“Now the names of the twelve apostles are these: The first, Simon, who is called Peter, and Andrew his brother; and James the son of Zebedee, and John his brother;”

FROM THE VIDEO Peter is first, not because he was called first, but because he leads the Twelve. Acts shows it: Peter preaches and performs miracles in its first half. Some scholars call him 'first among equals' (primus inter pares). Acts 2:14 Acts 3:6

BACKGROUND Every list of the Twelve puts Peter first and Judas Iscariot last (Mark 3:16-19; Luke 6:14-16; Acts 1:13). Mark 3:16-19 Luke 6:14-16

◆ Factbook: Peter (Simon Peter)

TWO BY TWO · MATTHEW 10:2-4

Named in pairs

MATTHEW 10:3-4 (LSB)

PAIRS

“Philip and Bartholomew; Thomas and Matthew the tax collector; James the son of Alphaeus, and Thaddaeus; Simon the Zealot, and Judas Iscariot, the one who betrayed Him.”

FROM THE VIDEO Matthew lists the Twelve in pairs; perhaps the very pairs that went out. Mark says Jesus sent them out 'in pairs' (Mark 6:7). Mark 6:7

FROM THE VIDEO Thaddaeus is likely the second Judas of the Twelve: Luke and Acts list 'Judas the son of James,' and John mentions 'Judas (not Iscariot).' Luke 6:16 Acts 1:13 John 14:22

BACKGROUND Matthew calls himself 'the tax collector' (10:3), the only list that does.

◆ Factbook: Matthew (apostle) ◆ Factbook: Tax collector

WHERE TO GO · MATTHEW 10:5-6

The lost sheep of Israel

MATTHEW 10:5-6 (LSB)

ISRAEL FIRST

“These twelve Jesus sent out after instructing them, saying, “Do not go in the way of the Gentiles, and do not enter any city of the Samaritans; but rather go to the lost sheep of the house of Israel.”

FROM THE VIDEO In practice: do not head north toward Tyre and Sidon, east toward the Decapolis, or south into the Samaritan towns. Stay in Galilee and minister to the Jews.

BACKGROUND Jesus says the same of His own mission in 15:24. After the resurrection He sends them to 'all the nations' (28:19). Matthew 15:24 Matthew 28:19

◆ Factbook: Gentiles ◆ Factbook: Galilee ◆ Factbook: Decapolis

> *The word apostle means one who is sent.*
>
> From the video

04 · FROM THE VIDEO · LSB TEXT

Good news before the cross

Lost sheep, the King on Zion, the Son of Man and the Branch.

LOST SHEEP · PSALM 119 AND JEREMIAH 50

Who to look for

THE PSALMIST · PSALM 119:176

“I have wandered off like a lost sheep; search for Your slave, / For I have not forgotten Your commandments.”

JEREMIAH · JEREMIAH 50:6

““My people have become lost sheep; / Their shepherds have led them astray. / They have made them turn away on the mountains;”

FROM THE VIDEO The psalmist knows God but has lost his way. Jesus is telling the apostles to look for that kind of person.

FROM THE VIDEO Jeremiah blames the shepherds: the religious leaders who failed to lead the flock. Ezekiel 34 says the same, and God promises to gather His sheep Himself. Ezekiel 34:11-12

◆ Factbook: Book of Psalms ◆ Factbook: Jeremiah (prophet) ◆ Factbook: Ezekiel (prophet)

THE KINGDOM IS AT HAND · PSALM 2

My King upon Zion

PSALM 2:6-7 (LSB)

THE KING

““But as for Me, I have installed My King / Upon Zion, My holy mountain.” “I will surely tell of the decree of Yahweh: / He said to Me, ‘You are My Son, / Today I have begotten You.”

FROM THE VIDEO How could they preach good news before the cross and resurrection? Their message was the kingdom (10:7). Psalm 2 looks to the great King on Zion, given the nations and the ends of the earth. Psalm 2:8

FROM THE VIDEO The good news before the cross was that the King had arrived. Afterward the resurrection became the proof that He is who He claimed to be.

◆ Factbook: Kingdom of heaven ◆ Factbook: God the Son

DANIEL 7:13-14

One like a Son of Man

DANIEL 7:14 (LSB)

DOMINION

“And to Him was given dominion, / Glory, and a kingdom, / That all the peoples, nations, and men of every tongue / Might serve Him. / His dominion is an everlasting dominion / Which will not be taken away; / And His kingdom is one / Which will not be destroyed.”

FROM THE VIDEO The video links Psalm 2 to Daniel 7: the Son of Man comes with the clouds to the Ancient of Days and receives a kingdom that will never pass away. Daniel 7:13

BACKGROUND Jesus calls Himself the Son of Man (8:20; 9:6), and at His trial quotes Daniel 7:13 (26:64). Matthew 26:64

◆ Factbook: Son of Man ◆ Factbook: Daniel (the prophet)

JEREMIAH 23:5-6

A righteous Branch for David

🌿 JEREMIAH 23:5 (LSB)

BRANCH

““Behold, the days are coming,” declares Yahweh, / “When I will raise up for David a righteous Branch; / And He will reign as king and prosper / And do justice and righteousness in the land.”

FROM THE VIDEO His name will be 'Yahweh our righteousness' (Jeremiah 23:6). All this is backdrop for what the apostles were to tell the towns: lost sheep, the kingdom, the King. Jesus gave them a solid biblical basis for their claims. Jeremiah 23:6

FROM THE VIDEO The signs go with the message: heal the sick, raise the dead, cleanse lepers, cast out demons (10:8). Jews who knew their Tanakh should have understood what these meant. Isaiah 35:5-6

◆ Factbook: David ◆ Factbook: Jeremiah (prophet) ◆ Factbook: Tanakh

> *“The good news was simply to proclaim that the king had arrived.*
>
> From the video

05 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND · LSB TEXT

Freely you received

Isaiah 55, traveling light, and the dust on their feet.



FREELY · MATTHEW 10:8 AND ISAIAH 55

Without money and without cost

JESUS · MATTHEW 10:8

“Heal the sick, raise the dead, cleanse the lepers, cast out demons. Freely you received, freely give.”

ISAIAH · ISAIAH 55:1

““Ho! Every one who thirsts, come to the waters; / And you who have no money come, buy and eat. / Come, buy wine and milk / Without money and without cost.”

FROM THE VIDEO Why jump from good news to money? The video says Jesus is drawing on Isaiah 55: come and buy what is actually free. It leads straight to an everlasting covenant 'according to the faithful lovingkindnesses of David' (55:3), a nod to David's throne. Isaiah 55:3

FROM THE VIDEO No money and no righteous deed can buy a place at God's royal banquet, yet He invites His people anyway. So the apostles must be radically generous with the message. The only requirement is that people listen and believe.

◆ Factbook: Isaiah ◆ Factbook: David



ISAIAH 53-55

With great compassion

💞 ISAIAH 54:7-8 (LSB)

COMPASSION

““For a brief moment I forsook you, / But with great compassion I will gather you. In a flood of fury / I hid My face from you for a moment, / But with everlasting lovingkindness I will have compassion on you,” / Says Yahweh your Redeemer.”

FROM THE VIDEO Isaiah 55 follows the suffering Servant of chapter 53, who 'interceded for the transgressors' (53:12), and the covenant of peace in chapter 54. Isaiah 53:12 Isaiah 54:10

FROM THE VIDEO Compassion links it all: Jesus saw shepherdless sheep and felt compassion (9:36); the Lord's compassion moves Him to redeem and bless His people. Matthew 9:36

◆ Factbook: Servant of the Lord



TAKE NOTHING · MATTHEW 10:9-11

The worker is worthy of his support

🎒 MATTHEW 10:9-11 (LSB) PROVISION

“Do not acquire gold, or silver, or copper for your money belts, or a bag for your journey, or even two tunics, or sandals, or a staff; for the worker is worthy of his support. And whatever city or village you enter, inquire who is worthy in it, and stay there until you leave.”

FROM THE VIDEO Taking almost nothing forced them to shun luxury and rely on God's provision. They do not need a resume-ready audience; they only need people willing to listen.

FROM THE VIDEO 'Inquire who is worthy': the video reads it as God having already prepared people to hear. Their job is not to make anyone worthy but to find those who are.

BACKGROUND Paul quotes Jesus' saying as Scripture: 'The laborer is worthy of his wages' (1 Timothy 5:18; Luke 10:7). 1 Timothy 5:18 Luke 10:7

◆ Factbook: Paul



PEACE OR DUST · MATTHEW 10:12-15

Shake the dust off your feet

👣 MATTHEW 10:13-14 (LSB) TESTIMONY

“And if the house is worthy, let your peace come upon it. But if it is not worthy, let your peace return to you. And whoever does not receive you, nor heed your words, as you leave that house or that city, shake the dust off your feet.”

FROM THE VIDEO Jesus does not tell them to win whole towns: they find individual houses, and a house that rejects them stands for the town. The video explains the dust as a Jewish custom on leaving Gentile land, so it marks the town as no different from the pagans.

BACKGROUND The connections the teacher leaves for you: David's greeting 'peace be to your house' (1 Samuel 25:6); Nehemiah shaking out his garment as a sign against those who break their word (Nehemiah 5:13); and Sodom and Gomorrah (Genesis 19:24-25). 1 Samuel 25:6 Nehemiah 5:13 Genesis 19:24-25

BACKGROUND Paul and Barnabas did it at Pisidian Antioch: 'having shaken off the dust of their feet against them, they went to Iconium' (Acts 13:51). Acts 13:51

◆ Factbook: Judgment

> *“Their job is to go looking for those people who are already worthy.*

From the video

06

Who's who in 10:1-15

What the video says, then a short background note.

Jesus

VIDEO Gives the Twelve authority, names them, and sends them with a message rooted in the Old Testament.

BACKGROUND This is the second of five long discourses in Matthew (chapters 5-7, 10, 13, 18, 24-25).

Matthew 11:1 · ◆ Jesus Christ

The Twelve apostles

VIDEO Disciples now sent as authorized representatives, two by two.

BACKGROUND Their names also appear in Mark 3:16-19, Luke 6:14-16 and Acts 1:13.

Mark 3:16-19 · Acts 1:13 · ◆ The Twelve · ◆ Apostle

Simon Peter

VIDEO Named first: first among equals in leadership.

BACKGROUND Matthew alone adds 'The first' to his name in the list.

Acts 2:14 · ◆ Peter (Simon Peter)

Matthew the tax collector

VIDEO Read in the list of names.

BACKGROUND Only Matthew's own list calls him 'the tax collector' (10:3); compare his call in 9:9.

Matthew 9:9 · ◆ Matthew (apostle) · ◆ Tax collector

Thaddaeus

VIDEO Likely the second Judas among the Twelve.

BACKGROUND Luke and Acts name 'Judas the son of James'; John 14:22 has 'Judas (not Iscariot).'

Luke 6:16 · John 14:22 · ◆ Thaddaeus (apostle)

Judas Iscariot

VIDEO Named last: 'the one who betrayed Him.'

BACKGROUND He is last in every list of the Twelve.

Matthew 26:14-16 · ◆ Judas Iscariot

The Samaritans

VIDEO Their towns were off-limits for this mission.

BACKGROUND Later Jesus sends His witnesses to 'Judea and Samaria' (Acts 1:8).

Acts 1:8 · ◆ Samaritans

Nehemiah

VIDEO One of the Old Testament connections to find.

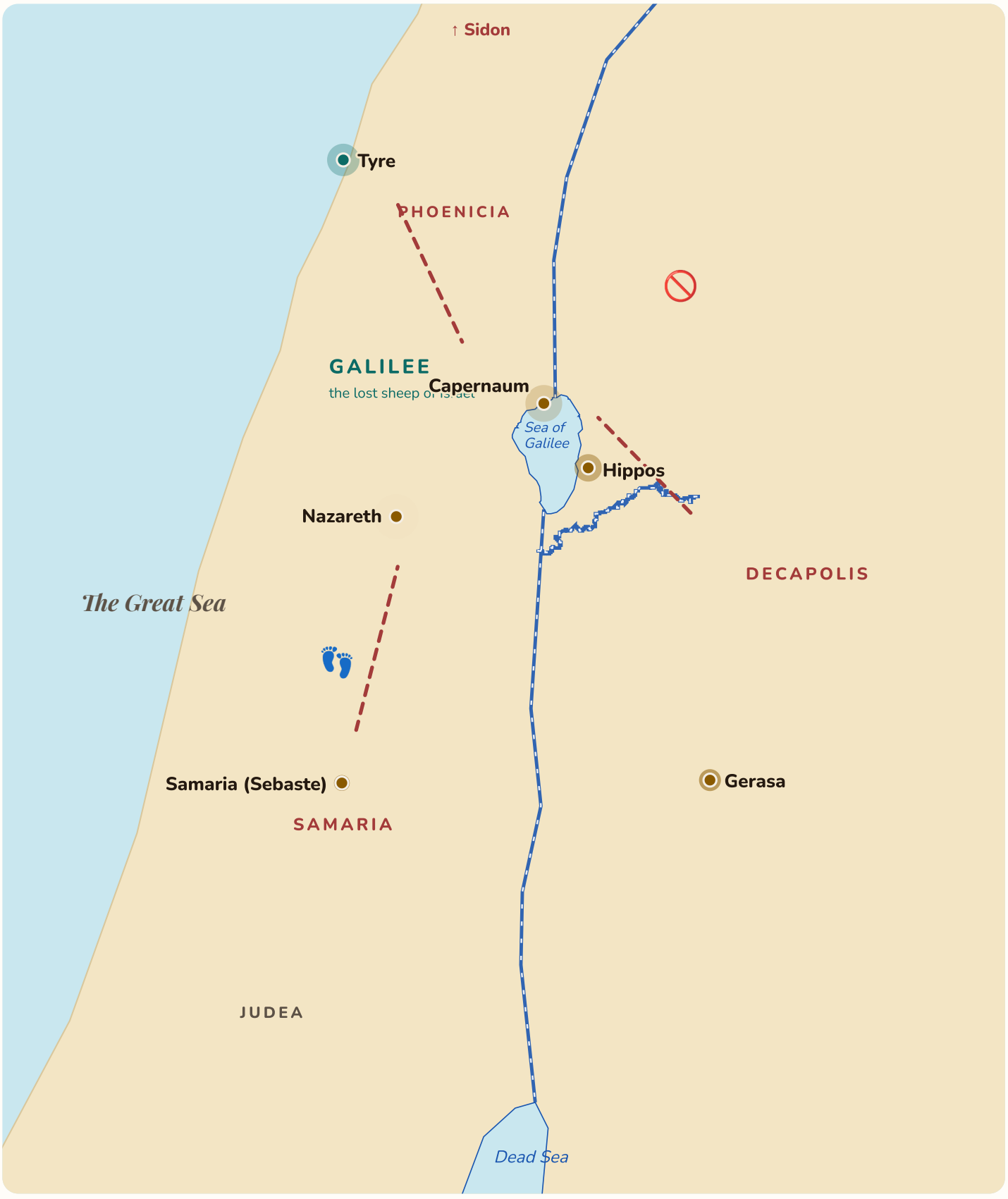
BACKGROUND He shook out his garment against anyone who broke the oath to free their brothers from debt.

Nehemiah 5:13 · ◆ Nehemiah (governor)

07 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND

Not north, east or south

Coral marks the directions the video says the Twelve were to avoid; the pin outlined in the video's color is a place the video names.



Positions of cities from their known sites; regions and arrows are approximate and schematic. Sidon lies just north of this map. Coastline, Dead Sea and most rivers: Natural Earth (public domain). Sea of Galilee outline and the Yarmuk River: OpenStreetMap contributors (ODbL).

Capernaum BACKGROUND
Jesus' base in Galilee, from which the Twelve were likely sent.

◆ Factbook: Capernaum

Tyre VIDEO
North: a Gentile city on the coast. The video: avoid going north toward Tyre and Sidon.

◆ Factbook: Tyre ◆ Factbook: Sidon

Hippos BACKGROUND
A Decapolis city across the lake.

◆ Factbook: Hippos ◆ Factbook: Decapolis

Gerasa BACKGROUND
A large Decapolis city east of the Jordan.

◆ Factbook: Gerasa ◆ Factbook: Decapolis

Samaria (Sebaste) BACKGROUND
South: the Samaritan heartland. 'Do not enter any city of the Samaritans.'

Nazareth BACKGROUND
One of the Galilean towns of the lost sheep of Israel.

◆ Factbook: Nazareth

08

Key terms

Apostle
VIDEO

Greek apostolos, 'one who is sent': an authorized representative. Matthew uses it only in 10:2.

◆ Factbook: The Twelve ◆ Factbook: Apostle

Talmid
VIDEO

Hebrew for a disciple: one being trained to be like his rabbi.

◆ Factbook: Disciples ◆ Factbook: Rabbi

Primus inter pares
VIDEO

Latin, 'first among equals': how some scholars describe Peter among the Twelve.

◆ Factbook: Peter (Simon Peter)

Second discourse
VIDEO

Matthew 10, the mission discourse: the second of Jesus' five long teachings in Matthew (after the Sermon on the Mount).

◆ Factbook: Sermon on the Mount

Kingdom of heaven
VIDEO

Matthew's usual phrase for God's kingdom: the reign of the promised King, now 'at hand.'

◆ Factbook: Kingdom of heaven

Lost sheep
VIDEO

God's people strayed or scattered (Psalm 119:176; Jeremiah 50:6).

◆ Factbook: Shepherd

Branch

BACKGROUND

A title for David's promised heir (Jeremiah 23:5; 33:15; Zechariah 3:8).

◆ Factbook: David ◆ Factbook: Branch (title)

Shaking off the dust

VIDEO

A sign of leaving a place that rejected the message: 'a testimony against them' (Mark 6:11).

◆ Factbook: Sodom and Gomorrah

09 · BACKGROUND

Hebrew and Greek words

Strong's numbers match the LSB's own word tagging for the verses listed. Glosses summarize the standard lexicons; 'Look up' points you to the entry to read for yourself (BDAG for Greek; BDB or HALOT for Hebrew).

ἀπόστολος

apostolos G652

One sent; messenger, apostle. Look up: BDAG, ἀπόστολος.

Greek · Matt 10:2

◆ Factbook: The Twelve ◆ Factbook: Apostle

πρῶτος

prōtos G4413

First (in order or rank).

Greek · Matt 10:2

ἀποστέλλω

apostellō G649

To send out (with a commission).

Greek · Matt 10:5

◆ Factbook: Apostle

ἀπόλλυμι

apollymi G622

To destroy; to lose; middle: be lost.

Greek · Matt 10:6

ἐγγίζω

engizō G1448

To draw near; 'is at hand.'

Greek · Matt 10:7

◆ Factbook: Kingdom of heaven

δωρεάν

dōrean G1432

As a gift, without payment; 'freely.' Look up: BDAG, δωρεάν.

Greek · Matt 10:8

ἄξιος

axios G514

Worthy, deserving, fit.

Greek · Matt 10:10, 11, 13

εἰρήνη

eirēnē G1515

Peace; the greeting of peace (Hebrew shalom).

Greek · Matt 10:13

ἐκτινάσσω

ektinassō `G1621`

To shake off or out.

Greek · Matt 10:14

κονιορτός

koniortos `G2868`

Dust.

Greek · Matt 10:14

ἀνεκτός

anektos `G414`

Bearable, tolerable.

Greek · Matt 10:15

אָבַד

abad `H6`

To perish; to be lost or strayed. Look up: BDB or HALOT, אבד.

Hebrew · Ps 119:176; Jer 50:6

◆ Factbook: Jeremiah (prophet)

שָׁלוֹם

shalom `H7965`

Peace, welfare, wholeness.

Hebrew · 1 Sam 25:6

נָעַר

naar `H5287`

To shake out or off.

Hebrew · Neh 5:13

צֶמַח

tsemach `H6780`

Sprout, branch; the messianic 'Branch.'

Hebrew · Jer 23:5

◆ Factbook: David ◆ Factbook: Branch (title)

מְחִיר

mechir `H4242`

Price, cost.

Hebrew · Isa 55:1

10

Historical and cultural background

ESTABLISHED **Facts most interpreters agree on**

Five discourses

Matthew gathers Jesus' teaching into five long discourses, each closing with a line like 'when Jesus had finished' (7:28; 11:1; 13:53; 19:1; 26:1). Many readers compare the five to the five books of Moses.

Galilee and its neighbors

Galilee was Jewish country ringed by others: Phoenician Tyre and Sidon to the north, the Greek cities of the Decapolis to the east, and Samaria to the south, whose people worshiped at Mount Gerizim (John 4:20).

Traveling light

Hospitality and the greeting of peace

A traveler normally carried a staff, a bag for food, coins in a belt, and a spare tunic. The Twelve were to go without and depend on the hospitality of the worthy.

A guest greeted a household with 'peace' (shalom), as David's men did (1 Samuel 25:6). Receiving the messenger meant receiving the one who sent him (10:40).

SOURCED

Early witnesses

> *See how He provides for their conduct, and that no less than for their miracles, implying that the miracles without this are nothing.*
>
> John Chrysostom, c. AD 390. Homilies on Matthew 32, on 10:8. Nicene and Post-Nicene Fathers, series 1, vol. 10 (public domain).

> *But what means, Shake off the dust of your feet? It is either to signify their having received nothing of them, or to be a witness to them of the long journey, which they had travelled for their sake.*
>
> John Chrysostom, c. AD 390. Homilies on Matthew 32, on 10:14. NPNF 1.10 (public domain).

> *Let every apostle that comes to you be received as the Lord. ... And when the apostle goes away, let him take nothing but bread until he lodges; but if he ask money, he is a false prophet.*
>
> The Didache, c. AD 50-120. Didache 11, an early Christian church manual. Ante-Nicene Fathers, vol. 7 (public domain).

DEBATED

Where scholars differ

Who is 'worthy'?

The video: people God has already prepared to hear. Chrysostom: a fit host who will feed them and whom they need not leave for a better house. Both readings keep the burden off the messengers.

A staff or no staff?

Matthew and Luke say take no staff (Matthew 10:10; Luke 9:3); Mark says 'except a staff only' (Mark 6:8). Matthew's verb is 'acquire': do not get extra gear for the trip. Readers explain the difference in several ways.

Why the dust?

The video: it treats the town like Gentile land. Chrysostom: a sign they took nothing from it, or a witness of the long journey made for its sake. Mark and Luke call it 'a testimony against them.'

Only to Israel?

This mission was to Israel (10:5-6; 15:24). After the resurrection the commission goes to all nations (28:19). Matthew holds both: Israel first, then the world.

CAREFUL READING

Small slips in the video

Small slips worth knowing (offered gently; the video's main points stand):

- The video says Jews shook Gentile dust off their feet when returning home. Commentaries often say this, but the Gospels do not explain the gesture beyond 'a testimony against them' (Mark 6:11; Luke 9:5), so hold that background loosely.
- Five discourses do structure Matthew, but the link to the five books of the Torah is an interpretation; Matthew never states it, and 'every good Jew would have recognized' it cannot be shown.
- The quotation from Gary Smith's New American Commentary on Isaiah could not be checked here; read it in the commentary itself before repeating it.
- The link from 'freely give' to Isaiah 55 is the video's reading: Isaiah speaks of buying 'without money and without cost,' while Jesus speaks of receiving and giving 'freely.' The idea fits; the wording is not a quotation.
- The video reads from another English translation ('You received without paying, give without pay'); the LSB has 'Freely you received, freely give' (10:8).

II · BACKGROUND

From Sodom to Chrysostom

Coral dots mark what Matthew 10:1-15 echoes or this episode covers. Early dates are approximate; dates tagged debated vary among scholars.

C. 2000 BC DEBATED
Fire on Sodom and Gomorrah
Genesis 19:24-29 *Echo: 10:15*

C. 1015 BC DEBATED
David's greeting: 'peace be to your house'
1 Samuel 25:6 *Echo: 10:12-13*

C. 700 BC DEBATED
Isaiah: buy without money and without cost
Isaiah 55:1-3 *Echo: 10:8*

C. 600 BC
Jeremiah: a righteous Branch for David
Jeremiah 23:5-6

C. 550 BC DEBATED
Daniel sees one like a Son of Man
Daniel 7:13-14

C. 445 BC
Nehemiah shakes out his garment
Nehemiah 5:13 *Echo: 10:14*

C. AD 29 DEBATED
The Twelve are sent to the lost sheep of Israel
Matthew 10:1-15 *This episode*

C. AD 47 DEBATED

Paul and Barnabas shake off the dust at Antioch
Acts 13:51

C. AD 50-120 DEBATED
The Didache: receive an apostle as the Lord
Matthew 10:40

C. AD 390
Chrysostom preaches on the sending of the Twelve
Matthew 10:1-15

12

Cross-references

Added cross-references for further study.

Mark 6:7-13
Sent out in pairs
ADDED

Luke 9:1-10
Sent out, and their return
ADDED

Luke 10:1-12
Seventy more sent with similar words
ADDED

John 14:22
Judas (not Iscariot)
ADDED

Ezekiel 34:11-16
God seeks His lost sheep
ADDED

Isaiah 35:4-6
The blind see, the lame leap
ADDED

Acts 13:51
Dust shaken off at Pisidian Antioch
ADDED

Acts 18:6
Paul shakes out his garments at Corinth
ADDED

2 Corinthians 2:17
Not peddling the word of God
ADDED

13

Reflection and discussion

0 of 6 questions marked done on this device.

1 ☐ What is the difference between a disciple and an apostle? Which describes where you are right now?

2 ☐ If you had only the Old Testament, how would you explain 'the kingdom of heaven is at hand'?

3 ☐ Which of the passages (Psalm 2, Daniel 7, Jeremiah 23, Isaiah 55) helps you most to see Jesus as King?

4 ☐ What have you 'freely received'? Where is God asking you to give freely?

5 ☐ Do you ever trust yourself to accomplish God's mission instead of the God who sent you?

6 ☐ Where do you see the Father already at work around you this week?

14

Application

FROM THE VIDEO

The lesson for the original audience: when God sends His people on a mission, He gives them everything they need to accomplish it. Not only food, supplies and shelter, but the very people who need to hear the message: 'inquire who is worthy.' The apostles did not have to make anyone worthy by their own great efforts; their job was to find those God had already prepared. The lesson is the same for us: if God sends us on a mission, He will give us everything we need. Sometimes we do not understand the mission in the moment, and sometimes we trust ourselves instead of the God who sent us. Jesus said, 'the Son can do nothing from Himself, unless it is something He sees the Father doing' (John 5:19). This is the way to do ministry: recognize what the Father is already doing and go be a part of it.

STUDY NOTE (ADDED)

before you plan your next act of service, pray through Matthew 10:7-8. Write down one place you see the Father already at work (a person, a need, an open door), and one thing you have freely received that you can freely give there this week.

> *"When God sends his people on a mission, he gives them everything they need to accomplish it.*
>
> From the video

15

Look it up in Logos

Each link opens that person, place or topic in the Logos Factbook, inside the Logos app on iPad, Mac or PC. The same links are in Copy all notes.

◆ Jesus Christ ◆ David ◆ Moses ◆ Nazareth ◆ Jordan River ◆ Isaiah ◆ Judgment ◆ Galilee
◆ Righteousness ◆ Kingdom of heaven ◆ Capernaum ◆ Decapolis ◆ Book of Psalms ◆ Worship
◆ God the Son ◆ John Chrysostom ◆ Andrew (apostle) ◆ Demon possession ◆ Didache ◆ Disciples
◆ Ezekiel (prophet) ◆ Gentiles ◆ Gerasa ◆ Gospel ◆ Healing ◆ Hippos ◆ James (son of Zebedee)
◆ Jeremiah (prophet) ◆ Judea ◆ Law of Moses ◆ Oath ◆ Prayer ◆ Sea of Galilee
◆ Sermon on the Mount ◆ Peter (Simon Peter) ◆ Tax collector ◆ The Twelve ◆ Zebedee
◆ Daniel (the prophet) ◆ False prophet ◆ Leprosy ◆ Matthew (apostle) ◆ Messianic banquet ◆ Paul
◆ Servant of the Lord ◆ Son of Man ◆ Tanakh ◆ Ancient of Days ◆ Apostle ◆ Bartholomew (apostle)
◆ Branch (title) ◆ Compassion ◆ James son of Alphaeus ◆ Judas Iscariot ◆ Nehemiah (governor)
◆ Philip (apostle) ◆ Rabbi ◆ Samaritans ◆ Shepherd ◆ Sidon ◆ Simon the Zealot
◆ Sodom and Gomorrah ◆ Thaddaeus (apostle) ◆ Thomas (apostle) ◆ Tyre

Source: the video's auto-generated YouTube captions, read in full. Scripture quotations are from the Legacy Standard Bible, copyright 2021 by The Lockman Foundation. All rights reserved. Chrysostom and the Didache: Nicene and Ante-Nicene Fathers (public domain). Images: Wikimedia Commons (James Tissot, Brooklyn Museum; public domain). Map data: Natural Earth (public domain) and OpenStreetMap contributors (ODbL).